

How to check a building contractor in Nigeria

Tick each item before you sign or send money. Use it on every firm you consider, including us.

Registrations

✓	Check	Where
☐	Company registered; RC number matches the contract	CAC public search: search.cac.gov.ng
☐	A named COREN-registered engineer is responsible for the structure	COREN: coren.gov.ng
☐	Drawings stamped by an ARCON-registered architect	ARCON: arcon.gov.ng
☐	Contractors' all-risk and third-party insurance from a NAICOM-licensed insurer	Ask for the policy schedule

Track record

✓	Check
☐	Visited or video-called a project finished in the last two years
☐	Spoke to at least two past clients
☐	Projects are like yours (homes vs roads vs towers)

Twelve questions to ask

✓	Question
☐	1. What is your RC number, and can I see the certificate?
☐	2. Which engineer is COREN-registered, and what is the number?
☐	3. Who is the architect, and are they ARCON-registered?
☐	4. Can I see a recent project and speak to that client?
☐	5. Will you give me an itemised bill of quantities?
☐	6. How are payments staged, and what is inspected before each one?
☐	7. Who inspects the work, and are they independent of you?
☐	8. What insurance covers the works, and who is the insurer?
☐	9. How will I see progress from abroad, and how often?
☐	10. How are changes priced and approved?
☐	11. What is the defects liability period, and what is retained until it ends?
☐	12. What documents do I get at handover?

Contract must include

✓	Term
☐	Scope, drawings and BOQ attached
☐	Stage payment schedule tied to inspections
☐	Programme with key dates
☐	Variation procedure (price and time agreed in writing first)
☐	Retention / defects liability period
☐	Insurance, ownership of materials, dispute resolution

Walk away if...

they give a lump sum with no breakdown · ask for large payments upfront · want payment to a personal account · have no projects you can see · resist written terms or an independent inspector.

Full guide: artemisatelierltd.com/guides/how-to-choose-a-building-contractor-in-nigeria